5.3 Impact of the War

The colonists celebrated Britain's victory in the French and Indian War. New York City even raised a statue of King George III. Would the colonists' love of the king endure? We'll see.

MAIN IDEA Victory in the French and Indian War expanded British territory but led to conflict with Native Americans in the Ohio Valley.

THE TREATY OF PARIS

In 1763, diplomats from Britain and France met in Paris to negotiate a **treaty**, or peace agreement. The resulting **Treaty of Paris** officially ended the French and Indian War.

According to its terms, France lost all of its territory—and thus all of its power—in North America. As Britain's ally, Spain acquired New Orleans and the Louisiana Territory west of the Mississippi. The British gained Canada from France and Florida from Spain in exchange for Cuba and the Philippines. Britain now controlled all of the land in North America east of the Mississippi River.

The colonists also reaped some rewards from the treaty. They received the right to fish in the North Atlantic off the coast of Canada. The colonists also assumed they were now free to settle the Ohio Valley.



PONTIAC'S REBELLION

Not everyone in North America was happy when the French and Indian War ended. The war had been a disaster for Native Americans. While the French had presented them with gifts each year, the British ended this custom and then raised prices on trade goods. Worse yet, the British government limited what—and how much—Native Americans could trade. Additionally, white settlers streamed into the Ohio Valley after the war, in clear violation of existing treaties.

The British trade policies and land-grabbing drove large numbers of Delaware, Shawnee, Iroquois, and other Native Americans to take up arms.

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PRIMARY SOURCE

When I go to see the English commander and say to him that some of our comrades are dead, instead of bewailing their death, as our French brothers do, he laughs at me and at you. If I ask for anything for our sick, he refuses with the reply that he has no use for us. From all this you can well see that they are seeking our ruin. Therefore, my brothers, we must all swear their destruction and wait no longer.

—Chief Pontiac in a speech to a council of Native Americans near Detroit, May 1763

Ottawa leader **Pontiac** urged Native Americans in the region to band together and rise up against the British. Many listened.

Pontiac had fought alongside the French in the French and Indian War. In 1763, he led Native Americans in launching what came to be called **Pontiac's Rebellion**. His forces defeated 13 British outposts. However, the British successfully defended their most important forts, including Fort Pitt, sometimes by ruthless means.

When Pontiac launched his rebellion, he needed help to replenish ammunition supplies and strengthen the Native Americans' ranks throughout the Great Lakes region and western Pennsylvania. He counted on the French to come to his aid. But they never did. Then, when British commanders met with Native American leaders at Fort Pitt, they are said to have given them smallpox-infested blankets and handkerchiefs as gifts, hoping to spread disease among many of the tribes.

Fighting continued for two more years. Sick of war, the king issued a proclamation that colonists could not settle west of a line drawn along the crest of the Appalachian Mountains from Maine to Georgia. This angered colonists, who wondered what they had been fighting for. They also resented the continued presence of British troops in their homeland. The soldiers and their somewhat coarse behavior served as a daily reminder of the mother colony. In time, colonists began to regard British authority more critically.

HISTORICAL THINKING

1. **READING CHECK** How did the Treaty of Paris affect power in North America?
2. **INTERPRET MAPS** Which countries gained the most territory after 1763?
3. **SYNTHESIZE** How did the outcome of the war impact Native Americans?

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